The chicken drumstick makes this a questionable dish for your vegetarian friends—unless you don't mind stretching the truth. It can, of course, be left out.

chickpea soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 15 MINS, PLUS OVERNIGHT SOAKING **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
COOK 1 HR 40 MINS

7oz (200g) chickpeas, soaked in water overnight, then drained
2.5 quarts (2.5 liters) cold water
1 chicken drumstick
4 tbsp olive oil
2 celery ribs, chopped
1 medium onion, chopped
1 medium leek, chopped
3 garlic cloves, finely sliced
salt and freshly ground black pepper
½ cup dry white wine
1 tbsp lemon juice
6 tbsp extra virgin olive oil, to serve
2 tbsp chopped chives and parsley, to garnish

1 Place the chickpeas in a saucepan with plenty of cold water and bring to a boil. Skim away any foam with a slotted spoon, then drain and return to the pan. Add the cold water and chicken, bring to a boil, and skim again. Cover with a lid and simmer for 1½ hours or until the peas are done. Lift out the chicken after 45 minutes, remove the meat, and set to one side.

2 Heat 1 tbsp of the oil in a frying pan, add the celery, onion, and leek, and cook for 5–10 minutes or until soft. Add the garlic, season with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then cook for another minute. Add the contents of the frying pan to the chickpeas, then stir in the cooked chicken. Pour in a little water if the mixture seems too thick to blend.

3 Transfer the soup to a blender and process in batches until smooth, adding the wine, lemon juice, and the remaining 3 tbsp olive oil in three or four stages. Season with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then return to the pan and heat through. Divide the soup among six bowls, float 1 tbsp of extra virgin olive oil on the top of each one, then serve garnished with the chopped chives and parsley.